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FROM PARIS TO FOREIGN OFFICE

Cypher /OTP

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Sir O. Harvey

No. 570
22nd November, 1951.

D. 12. 6 p.m. 22nd November, 1951.
R. 12.16 p.m. 22nd November, 1951.

PRIORITY
SECRET

FJ 10310/23

Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No. 570 of 22nd November

Repeated for information to Washington, Tokyo, Peking, Singapore, Tamsui

FJ 10310/23

Foreign Office telegram to Paris No. 1719: Japan and Formosa.

Following from Secretary of State.

Mr. Acheson asked to see me this evening about my message. He said that he was not quite clear how far I was in disagreement with what he had in mind. His idea was that the Japanese should be encouraged to get in touch with the authorities in Formosa for the purpose of regulating their relations on trade and other practical matters, but there would be no question of the Japanese reaching any formal arrangement until after the Japanese peace treaty had come into force. He certainly did not expect the Japanese to recognise the nationalist government of China or to have any treaty with them except by their own free will and after the treaty had come into force. If, however, they did wish to do so, the United States Government would prefer to encourage rather than discourage them.

2. I said that I entirely accepted the need for contacts and arrangements for practical purposes, but I thought that any question of their recognising Chiang Kai-shek or getting tied up with his régime would create great difficulties for us and for them in the future. Mr. Acheson replied that it had never been contemplated that Japan should recognise Chiang Kai-shek's government as the government of China. All he thought was that after the treaty they should make agreements with him as the de facto authority in Formosa. I asked him whether this might not have the appearance of an attempt by Japan to reopen the question of

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Paris telegram No. 570 to Foreign Office

Japan's claim to Formosa and he said that this was certainly a point which needed looking into. He agreed that it would never do if we appeared to be contemplating a return of Formosa to Japan.

3. We agreed that the right thing would be for Mr. Foster Dulles (who arrives in Tokyo about December 8th) to discuss the whole matter with Sir Esler Dening and reach agreement as to precisely what steps the Japanese might appropriately take vis-a-vis the authorities in Formosa on practical grounds. After this the two governments could look at the matter again.

Foreign Office please pass to Washington, Tokyo, Peking, Singapore and Tamsui as my telegrams Nos. 162, 3, 3, 17 and 1 respectively.

[Repeated to Washington, Tokyo, Peking, Singapore and Tamsui]

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Private Secretary
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